

Sparepath — a marketplace for industrial spare parts

The Problem

When a production line stops for a failed component, the plant manager has hours, not days. Finding the part means calling three distributors, waiting for quotes, and discovering that two of them do not stock it.

Meanwhile, European manufacturers hold an estimated €40B of spare parts inventory, much of it obsolete for the machine it was bought for and perfectly usable for someone else's. There is no liquid market for any of it.

Our Solution

Sparepath lets a plant search by part number, by machine model, or by photograph, and see available stock across distributors and other manufacturers' surplus inventory in one view.

Sellers list by uploading their inventory export; we normalise part numbers across eleven manufacturer naming conventions, which is the unglamorous work that makes the search actually return results. Buyers see availability, condition, location and delivery time, and order without a quote cycle.

Emergency orders ship the same day where stock is within 300 km. That is the case we win on.

The Market

European industrial MRO — maintenance, repair and operations — is a €95B market. Spare parts procurement is roughly €31B of it, and the surplus resale segment we are opening barely exists as a category today.

We sell to plant maintenance managers in discrete manufacturing: automotive suppliers, packaging, food processing.

Competition

Distributor catalogues are deep within their own brands and blind outside them. Two general industrial marketplaces exist but treat spare parts as another product category, without part number normalisation, which means their search fails on exactly the query that matters.

Our defensibility is the normalisation layer and the inventory already listed. Neither is impossible to replicate; both take time.

The Team

Pieter Vandenberg spent eleven years in industrial distribution, latterly running procurement for a packaging group with fourteen plants. Ana Sousa built search infrastructure at a European e-commerce company.

Seventeen people, six of them in the catalogue team that handles normalisation.

Traction

- 1,340 buying plants registered, 620 having ordered in the last quarter
- 210 selling organisations
- €18M in gross merchandise value over the last twelve months, up from €6M
- 2.1 million normalised part references

- median time from search to order: 11 minutes
- 44% of orders are for parts the buyer's usual distributor does not stock

Business Model

We charge sellers a commission on completed transactions and offer a subscription tier for buyers who want stock alerts on their machine fleet.

Volume has grown steadily and the subscription tier is being adopted. We expect the economics to improve as the catalogue deepens.

Go-To-Market

Direct outreach to maintenance managers, plus presence at industrial trade fairs where our buyers already go. Word of mouth within manufacturing groups has been our most effective channel — six of our largest buyers came from a single group's internal recommendation.

Funding

We are raising €13M to expand the catalogue team, open the Italian and Spanish markets, and build the machine-fleet monitoring that turns emergency buyers into subscribers.